

● Social Media Safety

⚠ Common Dangers

Here are the most common risks you face on social media, explained simply.

💡 WHY YOU NEED TO BE CAREFUL

Social media is like a busy city. There are helpful people, but there are also scammers, bullies. They might try to steal your personal info, trick you into clicking bad links, or spread lies. Knowing the risks helps you avoid them.



Fake Profiles

Not everyone is who they say they are. Scammers create fake accounts to:

- **Become your "friend"** and ask for money or gifts.
- **Catfish** — pretend to be someone else to start a fake relationship.
- **Steal your info** by asking personal questions.

✓ Tip: If you don't know them in real life, be very careful.



Scams & Phishing

Scammers send fake messages or posts to trick you. They might:

- **Send a fake link** that steals your password.
- **Promise a prize** if you click and share.
- **Pretend to be a company** (like your bank) to get your details.

✓ Tip: Always check the URL. If it looks strange, don't click.



Sharing Too Much

Posting personal info can be risky.

Bad people can use it to:

- **Find your home address** or phone number.
- **Guess your passwords** (like your pet's name or birthday).
- **Impersonate you** or steal your identity.

✓ Tip: Keep your personal info private. Only share with people you trust.



How to Report Bad Stuff

Reporting helps make social media a safer place for everyone. Here's how it works.



WE ALL HELP KEEP IT SAFE

Social media platforms can't check every single post. That's why they ask users to report bad content. When you report something, you are helping protect others from harm. It's like telling a teacher or a guard about a problem.



What to Report

You should report content that is:

- **Hateful** — attacks based on race, religion, or gender.
- **Bullying** — mean comments or threats.



How to Report

1. **Find the button** — usually it's three dots (⋮) or a flag icon.
2. **Pick a reason** — select why you are reporting it.

- **Scams** — fake offers or phishing links.
- **Fake news** — lies that could hurt people.
- **Violent or graphic** — gore or threats of violence.

KEEP THE COMMUNITY CLEAN

3. **Add details** — explain why it's harmful (optional but helpful).
4. **Submit** — send it off to the platform's review team.

✓ Tip: Reporting is anonymous. The person you report won't know it was you.

What Happens Next?

- **Review:** A real person or AI looks at your report.
- **Action:** If it breaks the rules, they will remove it.
- **Warning/Ban:** The person who posted it might get a warning or be banned.
- **You get a reply:** Most platforms let you know what they decided.

USUALLY TAKES 24-72 HOURS

Rules About Posting

Different countries have different rules about what you can post online. Here are some examples.

 KNOW THE RULES

Even if you are sitting at home, your post can be seen anywhere in the world. If you break the laws of that country, you could get into trouble. That's why it's smart to think before you post.

United States

- **Free speech** is protected, but **threats** and **defamation** (lying about someone) are illegal.
- **Section 230**: Platforms like Facebook are usually not responsible for what users post.

FREE SPEECH

European Union

- **Strong hate speech laws** — posting hateful content can be a crime.
- **GDPR**: Protects your personal data. Companies can't share it without your permission.

STRICT RULES

United Kingdom

- **Online Safety Act**: Platforms must protect users from harmful content.
- **Malicious Communications**: Sending nasty messages is against the law.

DUTY OF CARE

India

- **IT Act**: Makes cyber crimes (like posting obscene content) illegal.
- **24-hour rule**: Platforms must remove flagged content within a day.

FAST TAKEDOWN

i Simple rule: If you wouldn't say it in public to a stranger, don't post it online.

✓ Smart Habits

Use these simple habits to protect yourself and have a better experience on social media.

🔊 THINK BEFORE YOU CLICK

The best way to stay safe online is to slow down and think. Scammers and bullies rely on you acting fast. By building good habits, you make it much harder for them to trick you.



Use strong passwords

Don't use your name or birthday. Use a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols. Turn on 2FA (two-factor authentication) for extra safety.



Keep private stuff private

Your address, phone number, and plans for today shouldn't be shared with everyone. Only share with close friends.



Check before you trust

If a post seems shocking or too good to be true, check other news sources before sharing. Don't spread lies.



Report, don't share

If you see bad content, don't share it. Use the report button. Sharing it helps it spread.



Block the bullies

If someone is being mean, block them. You don't have to listen to their negativity. Protect your mental health.



Take a break

Too much social media can make you stressed or sad. It's okay to log off and enjoy the real world for a while.

Real Stories

These true stories show what can happen online. Learn from their mistakes so you don't make them.



The Facebook Quiz Scandal (2018)

DATA THEFT

MILLIONS OF USERS



Facebook & Cambridge Analytica



87 million people

What happened: A company created a fun personality quiz on Facebook. When people took the quiz, it stole their data and their friends' data. They used it to send targeted political ads.

 **Lesson:** Be careful which apps you allow. Don't give away your data for a silly quiz. Always check what permissions you are granting.

Hate Speech in Myanmar (2018)

HATE SPEECH

REAL-WORLD VIOLENCE

 Southeast Asia  Minority group attacked

What happened: People used Facebook to spread hateful lies about a minority group. The platform didn't remove the posts quickly enough. This led to violence and suffering in real life.

 **Lesson:** Hate speech is dangerous. Platforms need to act faster. If you see hate speech, report it immediately. It can save lives.

Man Sued for a Fake Tweet (UK, 2022)

LEGAL TROUBLE

DAMAGES

 UK High Court  Public figure

What happened: A Twitter user posted a lie about a famous person. The tweet went viral. The famous person sued, and the user had to pay a lot of money in damages.

 **Lesson:** You are responsible for what you post. Sharing a lie can get you into serious legal trouble. Always verify the facts.

Teen Bullied on Instagram (2023)

BULLYING

MENTAL HEALTH

 USA  Cyberbullying

What happened: A teenager was bullied online by fake accounts. The bullies sent nasty messages and made fun of them. It caused a lot of stress and sadness.

 **Lesson:** Bullying is never okay. If you are being bullied, report it, block the bullies, and tell an adult you trust. You are not alone.

→ **Remember: Social media can be fun, but always stay smart. Use strong passwords, keep your info private, report bad stuff, and be kind to others.**